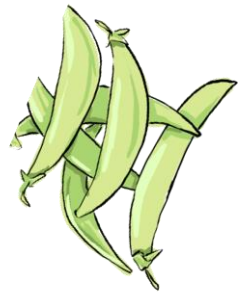
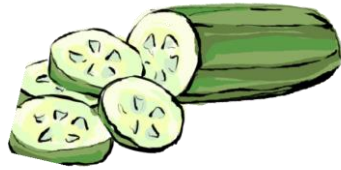


HUNGER vs CRAVINGS

Let's figure out together the difference between being hungry and having a craving:



Identifying the difference between the two is important to help learn more about your patterns and relationship with food.

Hunger is a physiological state where you feel the need to eat and any food will do. Cravings are for a specific type of food. When you are hungry, a vegetable may seem like just the right thing. If you are craving, a vegetable wouldn't cross your mind as something to satisfy you.

Your cravings are not due to a lack of willpower!

Cravings can be caused by metabolic dysfunction, meaning hormones may be sending the wrong signals. That's why we often have more cravings when we're overtired or stressed. If cravings are triggered by a metabolic reason, we can help with that!

Why you might be craving:

- Poor sleep or irregular sleep patterns
- Chronic stress
- Insulin resistance/poor blood sugar control
- Some medications
- Negative emotions
- Longstanding behaviors



TAKE ACTION!

When it comes to cravings, gaining control through improving your awareness is key.

REFLECT

Identify any habits or patterns to your cravings. Do you crave something sweet at a specific time of day or associate sweetness with a specific activity?

START WITH HOME

- Remove the foods from your house that call to you from behind the cabinets. You are more likely to eat ice cream if it is sitting in the freezer than if you have to leave the house to get it!
- Do not be afraid to throw unhealthy food away! It will either go to waste in the garbage can or go to waste in your body when you eat it.

THINK ABOUT THE FUTURE

Picture how you will feel and/or how the situation will look like in 15 minutes if you give into your cravings. Often times, the few minutes it takes to satisfy a craving will not be worth the distress you experience afterwards- both physically and mentally.

FIND DISTRACTIONS

Get your mind off food! Try these ideas to focus on other things other than food.

Go for a walk.

Meditate. (Calm app for guided)

Listen to music/podcasts.

Read.

Call a friend.

Leave the room the temptation is in.

STRUGGLING TO IGNORE?

Use mindfulness of body - Practice being "comfortable being uncomfortable". It is okay to desire food others are eating. Make sure to give yourself credit for not giving in... it's hard!

Practice delayed gratification - Don't give into the craving immediately. Set a timer for 5 minutes when you notice a craving. This will provide time to let the craving pass before indulging.

Make an "insightful" choice rather than an "impulsive" choice by considering some of the above examples (stress, fatigue) that may be triggering a craving. If you can identify that you want candy because you had a bad day at work or couldn't fall asleep the night before, you may be able to keep yourself on track instead of giving in!

Remember, the more often you ignore or successfully avoid giving into a

craving, the easier it gets! Practice makes perfect.